

Captain School Syllabus

Officer Formation Level II

Course purpose. Captain School forms the officer who can be trusted with local command. It is the transition from dependable junior officer to responsible steward of a body: a man who can organize operations, preserve standards, mentor lieutenants, coordinate resources, care for the brothers under his charge, and sustain the life of the Order at the local level.

Historical Foundation

The historical model for Captain School is the **Commander / Preceptor**. In the Templar hierarchy, the preceptor or commander was responsible for **administration and provisions**, and commanders of local commanderies were charged with the **day-to-day operations** of houses, estates, castles, and jurisdictions under their care. These offices formed the practical backbone of the Order and provide the clearest model for local-command leadership.

Course-Wide Learning Objectives

Objective Area	Course-Wide Objective
Templar identity	Explain how Templar commanderies and preceptories functioned and why local command was essential to the strength of the Order.
Officer responsibility	Describe the role of a Captain as a steward of local operations, standards, people, and resources.
Leadership under authority	Demonstrate the ability to govern a local body in alignment with the Order’s mission and higher authority.
Character formation	Practice humility, disciplined speech, consistency, prudence, and visible reliability in office.
Leader development	Mentor lieutenants and emerging officers through example, correction, and delegated responsibility.
Promotion readiness	Show evidence of readiness for wider oversight through practical local-command leadership, mentoring, and final board review.

12-Lesson Syllabus Overview

Lesson	Title	Learning Objectives	Assignment	
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				Leadership Outcome
1	The Burden of Local Command	Define the purpose of Captain School; explain the difference between leading tasks and governing a body; identify the responsibilities of a Captain in your Order.	1-2 page reflection: "What changes when a man becomes responsible for a body instead of a task?"	Begins to think like a steward of people, culture, and order.
2	The Medieval Commandery	Summarize how Templar commanderies functioned; explain why local houses were vital to the Order's mission and stability.	Short presentation or visual summary on the structure and purpose of a Templar commandery.	Understands the local-command model historically.
3	The Office of Commander / Preceptor	Describe the duties of the preceptor/ commander in administration, provisions, and daily governance; connect those duties to your Captain rank.	2-page comparison: "The Templar Commander and the modern Captain in our Order."	Sees Captaincy as active stewardship, not status.
4	Mission, Standards, and Local Identity	Explain how a local body can remain aligned to the wider Order while developing a healthy command culture.	Draft a one-page statement of local mission, standards, and officer expectations.	Understands how to preserve identity without rigidity.
5	Administration and Provisions	Learn the historical importance of provisions and local administration; apply those ideas to scheduling, logistics, records, readiness, and support functions.	Build a practical operations plan for one month of local activity.	Grows in organized, sustainable leadership.
6	Authority, Delegation, and Accountability	Distinguish between doing everything personally and governing through delegated responsibility; learn how to assign, supervise, and review the work of lieutenants.	Create a delegation map for a local team or officer corps.	Can govern through other leaders instead of over-controlling them.
7	The Rule: Humility,	Apply the Rule's warnings against envy,	Keep a 7-day command-presence	Develops mature command

	Speech, and Order	rumor, spite, and disorder to the life of a local command; define disciplined officer speech.	log focused on speech, correction, listening, and tone.	presence and verbal discipline.
8	Care of Brothers and Pastoral Stewardship	Explain what it means for a Captain to care for brothers, especially the weaker, newer, or struggling members; connect structure to human care.	Conduct two pastoral check-ins with members and submit a reflection on observations and action steps.	Grows in relational stewardship and responsibility.
9	Training Lieutenants and Building Future Officers	Learn how a Captain multiplies strength by forming junior officers; identify habits of mentoring, correction, and leadership development.	Design a 4-week mentoring outline for a Lieutenant or candidate.	Becomes a developer of leaders, not just a manager of duties.
10	Conflict, Discipline, and Restoration	Learn how to address disorder, lateness, weak performance, and interpersonal conflict without feeding division; practice correction that protects both standards and brotherhood.	Write case-study responses to three local-command conflict scenarios.	Learns to preserve both discipline and fraternity.
11	Local Command Practicum	Demonstrate the ability to organize and lead a real local initiative, event, training cycle, or service effort from planning through execution.	Lead an approved local-command project and submit an after-action review.	Proves he can sustain order in practice.
12	Capstone Preparation and Captain's Board Review	Integrate course learning; prepare for final portfolio, practicum review, and oral board.	Submit final portfolio: reflections, operations plan, mentoring outline, practicum summary, and self-assessment.	Demonstrates readiness for second-level officer stewardship.

Lesson Details

Lesson 1 — The Burden of Local Command

Focus: The Captain is no longer just a reliable officer under supervision, but a steward responsible for the health of a local body.

Leadership emphasis: The Captain is accountable not only for what happens, but for what becomes normal under his influence.

Assignment: 1-2 page reflection on responsibility for a body rather than a task.

Lesson 2 — The Medieval Commandery

Focus: The commandery as a functioning local center of mission, discipline, logistics, and communal life.

Leadership emphasis: A commandery was not just a place; it was an organized expression of mission.

Assignment: Short presentation or visual summary on the Templar commandery.

Lesson 3 — The Office of Commander / Preceptor

Focus: The preceptor/commander as the historical model for Captaincy, linking administration and provisions with local governance.

Leadership emphasis: Command is not merely giving orders; it is sustaining the conditions for mission to succeed.

Assignment: Comparison paper between the Templar commander and your Captain rank.

Lesson 4 — Mission, Standards, and Local Identity

Focus: How a local body reflects the wider Order without becoming chaotic or rigid.

Leadership emphasis: Every local body teaches the Order's identity by what it tolerates and what it models.

Assignment: One-page local mission and standards statement.

Lesson 5 — Administration and Provisions

Focus: Calendars, communications, training rhythm, event support, logistics, and practical order.

Leadership emphasis: Administrative order is not secondary to leadership; it makes leadership possible.

Assignment: One-month local operations plan.

Lesson 6 — Authority, Delegation, and Accountability

Focus: Governing through lieutenants instead of trying to do everything personally.

Leadership emphasis: A Captain who cannot delegate will either burn out or stunt the growth of others.

Assignment: Delegation map for a local team or officer corps.

Lesson 7 — The Rule: Humility, Speech, and Order

Focus: Humility, restraint, disciplined speech, and the rejection of rumor, spite, and disorderly conduct.

Leadership emphasis: The Captain's speech becomes the climate of the command.

Assignment: 7-day command-presence log.

Lesson 8 — Care of Brothers and Pastoral Stewardship

Focus: Attentive care for the weak, newer, or struggling members of the brotherhood.

Leadership emphasis: Leadership is not only structural; it is also pastoral.

Assignment: Two pastoral check-ins with written reflection.

Lesson 9 — Training Lieutenants and Building Future Officers

Focus: Multiplying strength by forming junior officers through mentoring, correction, and delegated responsibility.

Leadership emphasis: The Captain's legacy is visible in the officers he forms.

Assignment: 4-week mentoring outline for a Lieutenant or candidate.

Lesson 10 — Conflict, Discipline, and Restoration

Focus: Addressing disorder, weak performance, and interpersonal conflict with justice, restraint, and a commitment to restoration.

Leadership emphasis: Correction should protect the brotherhood, not poison it.

Assignment: Case-study responses to local conflict scenarios.

Lesson 11 — Local Command Practicum

Focus: Leading a real initiative from planning to execution while organizing people, communicating clearly, and adapting as needed.

Leadership emphasis: Command must be demonstrated, not merely described.

Assignment: Approved local-command project with after-action review.

Lesson 12 — Capstone Preparation and Captain's Board Review

Focus: Integrating course learning for final portfolio and oral board evaluation.

Leadership emphasis: Readiness for Captaincy must be visible in both conduct and command.

Assignment: Final portfolio submission.

Required Assignments Summary

Assignment	Purpose
Reflection on the burden of local command	Clarify the candidate's understanding of stewardship beyond task leadership.
Templar commandery summary/presentation	Establish historical understanding of local command.
Commander / Preceptor comparison paper	Link the historical office to the Captain rank.
Local mission and standards statement	Build cultural and organizational clarity.
One-month operations plan	Develop practical administrative and planning skill.
Delegation map	Learn to govern through junior officers effectively.
Command-presence self-log	Increase awareness of speech, tone, and bearing.
Pastoral check-in reflection	Build care-oriented local leadership.
Mentoring outline for a Lieutenant	Practice multiplying future officers.
Conflict case-study paper	Form skill in correction, discipline, and restoration.
Local-command practicum and AAR	Demonstrate applied command ability.
Final portfolio	Integrate all work for board review.

Leadership Outcomes

Leadership Domain	Expected Outcome
Identity	Understands the Templar commandery model and the meaning of local command.
Stewardship	Demonstrates responsibility for people, standards, operations, and resources.
Discipline	Shows consistency, preparation, prudent judgment, and orderly administration.
Obedience	Governs in alignment with the wider Order rather than personal preference.
Humility	Exercises authority without vanity or self-importance.

Speech and tone	Communicates with maturity, avoids corrosive speech, and preserves local unity.
Care of brothers	Knows how to support, monitor, and shepherd members under his charge.
Leader development	Mentors lieutenants and builds future officers intentionally.
Execution	Can plan and lead a local initiative from preparation through review.
Promotion readiness	Shows evidence of fitness for wider oversight and more complex stewardship.

Final Evaluation

Component	Weight	What is assessed
Attendance and participation	10%	Presence, preparedness, engagement, contribution to discussion.
Written assignments	20%	Historical understanding, reflection quality, and practical application.
Operations plan / administration assignment	10%	Planning, organization, feasibility, and stewardship.
Delegation and mentoring assignments	10%	Ability to develop lieutenants and structure responsibility.
Local-command practicum	20%	Leadership execution, communication, adaptability, and follow-through.
Mentor / senior observation	10%	Bearing, humility, command tone, discipline, and relational stewardship.
Final portfolio	10%	Integration, completeness, self-awareness, and officer readiness.
Oral board / final review	10%	Officer presence, judgment, historical grounding, and readiness for Captaincy.

Sample Oral Board Questions

- Why were commanderies essential to the historical Templar Order?
- What distinguishes a Captain from a Lieutenant in your Order?
- Why is the Commander / Preceptor the right model for Captain School?
- What must a Captain protect in a local body besides outward efficiency?
- How do you know whether you are truly delegating rather than merely assigning tasks?
- What does care of brothers look like at the local-command level?

- How should a Captain respond when standards are slipping without becoming harsh or reactive?
- How will you know whether your lieutenants are actually growing?
- Where is your greatest weakness as a future Captain, and how are you addressing it?
- Why are you ready—or not yet ready—for local command?

Practicum Requirement

The candidate must complete one approved local-command practicum, such as planning and leading a monthly command cycle, organizing a service project, coordinating a local officer team for an event or ceremony, establishing a training rhythm for lieutenants, or leading a membership-development effort. The practicum should include supervisor observation and an after-action review.

Promotion Recommendation Standard

A candidate should be recommended only if he completes the course requirements, demonstrates stable and disciplined conduct, shows competence in administration and local planning, leads the practicum successfully, passes the oral board, and proves he can sustain a healthy local body rather than merely perform as an individual officer.

Historical sources used in drafting this syllabus:

Wikipedia — Knights Templar: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Knights_Templar

Medieval Warfare — Templars hierarchy and duties: <https://www.medievalwarfare.info/templars.htm>

Medieval Warfare — Primitive Rule of the Templars: <https://www.medievalwarfare.info/rule.htm>